Best Apps to Practice English Speaking (2026)

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SEO essentials

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There's no single "best" app to practice English speaking — **the right one depends on your goal and budget. For daily conversation practice without a human, use an AI conversation app; for personalised feedback and real human interaction, use a live-tutor platform; and for accent and clarity, use a pronunciation app.**

The biggest shift since 2023 is AI conversation apps: you talk, the AI talks back, nobody judges you, and a session costs nothing to schedule. For most learners, the sweet spot is one AI app for daily reps plus occasional human practice. This guide compares the main options by type, price, and what each is actually good at, so you can pick the one that fits you.

What to look for in a speaking app

Before comparing names, know what actually matters. A good speaking-practice app should score well on these:

- **Real speaking time.** The core loop must make you *produce* speech out loud, not just tap answers or repeat single sentences. Open, unscripted conversation beats scripted drills for fluency.
- **Feedback.** It should tell you what to fix — pronunciation, grammar, word choice — not just let you talk into the void.
- **Availability.** Daily practice is what builds fluency, so the app needs to be there whenever you have a few minutes, with no scheduling.
- **Cost for daily use.** The real question isn't the headline price — it's what daily practice costs per month. Per-minute human tutoring looks cheap per session but adds up fast.
- **Level and goal fit.** Beginner vs advanced, and general conversation vs exam or business English, need different tools.
- **Low pressure.** If fear of judgment stops you speaking, a judgment-free option matters more than any feature.

Keep these in mind as you read — the "best" app is simply the one that scores highest on the criteria that matter most to *you*.

At a glance

App	Type	Best for	Approx. price
Yappply	AI conversation	Affordable daily AI conversation with feedback	From PKR 4,999/mo
Speak	AI conversation	A structured AI speaking curriculum	~$14–20/mo
Loora	AI conversation	Business & professional English	Paid (subscription)
ChatGPT / Gemini voice	General AI	Free, do-anything practice (no curriculum)	Free / low cost
ELSA Speak	Pronunciation	Accent & pronunciation drilling	~$6–12/mo
Cambly	Live tutors	On-demand native-speaker conversation	~$20–45+/mo
Preply / italki	Live tutors	Personalised 1-on-1 lessons & exam prep	Per lesson (~$5–30+/hr)
Duolingo	Gamified	A free, gamified base (limited speaking)	Free / ~$7/mo

Prices are approximate as of 2026 and vary by plan, region, and promotions — check each app's current pricing before you buy. The next section breaks down what each is actually good at.

The apps, by type

AI conversation apps

You talk, the AI responds in real time, and you get feedback — the closest thing to a conversation partner available on demand.

- **Yappply** is an AI English-speaking app built around daily conversation practice with Yappy, an AI partner. You get a focused daily speaking session on unlimited topics, live corrections as you talk, and a progress report after each session — all judgment-free and priced for South-Asian budgets (from PKR 4,999/month). *Best for* learners, especially in Pakistan and the region, who want affordable daily conversation reps with feedback. It's newer than the big names, which is worth knowing, but it's purpose-built for exactly the understand-but-can't-speak problem.

- **Speak** offers a structured AI speaking curriculum — lessons plus an AI tutor. *Best for* learners who want a guided path rather than open chat; priced in USD, so it's pricier in the region.
- **Loora** is an AI coach leaning toward work contexts — interviews, meetings, presentations. *Best for* professional English.
- **ChatGPT or Gemini voice mode** can hold open-ended spoken conversations for free or cheaply. *Best for* self-directed learners happy to design their own practice, though there's no curriculum or structured feedback.

Live-tutor platforms

Real humans over video — the richest feedback, but the most expensive for daily use.

- **Cambly** connects you to native speakers on demand. *Best for* learners who value human conversation and can pay monthly for a set number of minutes.
- **Preply and italki** are tutor marketplaces where you book 1-on-1 lessons and pay per lesson. *Best for* personalised lessons and exam prep; cost depends on how often you book, and daily use gets expensive.

Pronunciation & gamified apps

- **ELSA Speak** specialises in phoneme-level pronunciation and accent feedback. *Best for* clarity and accent, less so for open conversation. (See our articulation guide for free drills in the same spirit.)
- **Duolingo** is a free, gamified all-rounder. *Best for* a daily habit and vocabulary base, but its speaking practice is limited — it won't make you conversational on its own.

How to choose the right one for you

Match the app to your main goal:

- **You freeze or hesitate and need daily speaking reps:** an AI conversation app. It gives you unlimited, judgment-free practice whenever you have a few minutes — the single biggest fix for the understand-but-can't-speak gap.
- **You want human feedback and can budget for it:** a live tutor (Cambly, Preply, or italki), ideally one or two sessions a week.
- **Your accent or clarity is the issue:** a pronunciation app like ELSA, used 10 minutes a day.
- **You're on a tight budget:** a free AI voice tool or a free tier, plus consistency.

For most learners, the smartest setup is **one AI conversation app for daily practice, plus occasional human conversation** when you can afford it. The AI gives you the volume and the safe space; the human adds real-world nuance.

If daily, affordable conversation practice is what you're after — especially if you're learning in Pakistan or South Asia — that's exactly what Yappply is built for: a judgment-free AI partner, live corrections, and a progress report after every session, so you actually speak every day and can see yourself improving. It's the lowest-pressure way to turn the English you understand into English you can speak.

Frequently asked questions

What is the best app to practice English speaking? There's no single best app — it depends on your goal. For daily conversation reps, use an AI conversation app; for human feedback, a live-tutor platform like Cambly or Preply; for accent, a pronunciation app like ELSA Speak. Most learners do best pairing an AI app with occasional human practice.

Can I practice English speaking with AI? Yes. AI conversation apps let you have real spoken conversations any time, with instant feedback and no judgment or scheduling. They're the most practical way to get daily speaking reps when you don't have a partner.

Is there a good free app to practice English speaking? Yes — free AI voice tools like ChatGPT Voice and Gemini Live, and free tiers on dedicated speaking apps, let you practice at no cost. The trade-off is less structure and lighter feedback than paid, purpose-built apps.

Which is better for speaking: an app or a human tutor? They do different jobs. An app gives you cheap, daily, judgment-free volume; a human tutor gives richer feedback and real-world nuance but costs more per session. The strongest routine combines both.

How often should I use a speaking app to improve? Daily, even 10–15 minutes. Consistent short sessions build fluency far faster than occasional long ones.

Sources

App features, categories, and approximate pricing were drawn from these comparisons (verify current prices on each app's own site):

- HelloTalk — best AI English speaking apps (2026)
- Talkio — 10 best AI speaking apps (2026)
- TalkDrill — best AI English platforms: pricing by app
- LearnEnglish.Life — Cambly vs ELSA pricing
- LearnEnglish.Life — Preply/italki cost guides

- Fluently — best apps for English speaking practice

Yappply details are from the product itself. Before publishing, confirm each competitor's current pricing and plan names, since these change often and vary by country.